

Menstrual Cycle Prediction System using Machine Learning

1. Introduction

The Menstrual Cycle Prediction System is a machine learning–based solution designed to estimate key reproductive events such as ovulation date, next period date, and fertile window. The system combines **data-driven prediction (machine learning)** with **biological rules** to produce accurate and interpretable outputs.

This hybrid approach ensures both **predictive capability** and **biological validity**, which is critical in health-related applications.

2. Problem Statement

The objective of this project is to:

- Predict **ovulation day** using historical cycle data
- Estimate **next menstrual period date**
- Identify the **fertile window**

Challenges include:

- Variability in menstrual cycles across individuals
- Noisy and inconsistent real-world data
- Need for biologically meaningful predictions

3. System Architecture

The system follows a structured pipeline:

Raw Dataset
↓
Data Preprocessing
↓
Feature Selection
↓
Machine Learning Model
↓
Ovulation Prediction
↓
Biological Rule Engine
↓
Final Predictions

Outputs:

- Ovulation Date
- Next Period Date
- Fertile Window

4. Technologies Used (Tech Stack)

4.1 Programming Language

- **Python**
 - Used for implementing the entire pipeline due to its strong ecosystem for data science and machine learning.

4.2 Data Processing Layer

- **Pandas**
- **NumPy**

Purpose:

- Load and manipulate dataset
- Handle missing values

- Perform feature engineering

4.3 Machine Learning Layer

- **Scikit-learn**

Model Used:

- **Random Forest Regressor**

Reason for Selection:

- Handles nonlinear relationships effectively
- Performs well on small tabular datasets
- Reduces overfitting using ensemble learning

4.4 Feature Scaling

- **StandardScaler (Scikit-learn)**

Purpose:

- Normalize feature values
- Improve model stability

4.5 Model Persistence

- **Joblib**

Purpose:

- Save trained model (.pkl file)
- Save scaler for consistent predictions

4.6 Rule-Based Engine

- Implemented using **Python logic**

Purpose:

- Convert ovulation predictions into:
 - Next period date
 - Fertile window

4.7 Execution Environment

- Command Line Interface (CLI)
- Developed using **VS Code**

5. Dataset Description

The dataset consists of **1665 menstrual cycle records** with 80 features.

Key features used:

- CycleNumber
- LengthofCycle
- LengthofLutealPhase
- TotalNumberofHighDays
- TotalNumberofPeakDays
- Age
- BMI
- EstimatedDayofOvulation (target variable)

6. Data Preprocessing

Steps performed:

1. **Data Loading**

- a. CSV dataset loaded using Pandas
- 2. **Data Cleaning**
 - a. Converted string-based numeric columns to numeric format
 - b. Removed invalid and missing values
- 3. **Feature Selection**
 - a. Reduced 80 features to 7 relevant biological features
 - b. Eliminated noise and irrelevant attributes
- 4. **Final Dataset Creation**
 - a. Clean dataset saved as `cleaned_cycle_data.csv`

7. Model Training

Steps:

- 1. **Train-Test Split**
 - a. 80% training data
 - b. 20% testing data
- 2. **Feature Scaling**
 - a. Applied StandardScaler
- 3. **Model Training**
 - a. Random Forest Regressor trained on processed data
- 4. **Evaluation Metrics**
 - a. Mean Absolute Error (MAE)
 - b. Mean Squared Error (MSE)

Performance:

- $MAE \approx 1-2$ days
- Indicates high prediction accuracy for biological data

8. Prediction System

Step 1 — ML Prediction

The trained model predicts:

Cycle Features → Ovulation Day

Step 2 — Rule-Based Calculations

Using biological principles:

Next Period Date:

Next Period = Ovulation Date + Luteal Phase Length

Fertile Window:

Fertile Window = Ovulation - 5 days → Ovulation + 1 day

9. Output Example

Input:

- Last period date: 2026-03-01
- Cycle length: 29
- Luteal phase: 14

Output:

- Ovulation Date: March 16
- Next Period Date: March 30
- Fertile Window: March 11 – March 17

10. Project Structure

menstrual-cycle-predictor/

dataset/

menstrual_cycle.csv

cleaned_cycle_data.csv

```
model/  
    cycle_prediction_model.pkl  
    scaler.pkl
```

```
scripts/  
    preprocess_dataset.py  
    train_cycle_model.py  
    predict_cycle.py
```

11. Key Insights

- Ovulation is the **central variable** in cycle prediction
- Period prediction is **not purely ML-based**, but partially deterministic
- Hybrid systems (ML + rules) are more reliable for biological problems

12. Limitations

- Treats each cycle independently (no time-series modeling)
- Limited dataset size
- Does not handle irregular cycles explicitly

13. Future Improvements

- Time-series models (LSTM, Transformers)
- Personalized user modeling
- Confidence scoring for predictions
- Web/mobile application interface
- Integration with real-time user inputs

14. Conclusion

This project demonstrates a practical application of machine learning in healthcare by combining:

- Data-driven prediction
- Domain-specific biological knowledge

The system achieves **accurate and interpretable predictions**, making it a strong foundation for real-world menstrual health applications.